

Arianna Griffiths

Link to my Kumu network make: <https://kumu.io/griffia1/dh101-network-1#dh101-network>

Network Analysis (300 words)

- What is the most central node? Why?
- What clusters/groups emerged?
- What was surprising?
- What is MISSING from this network?

Microsoft Azure, the computing system, could be seen as the most central node in this case because it is the meeting point between the physical hardware and the user-accessible software that is online. There were several groups that emerged in the network, specifically the facilities, materials, and companies. For example, cobalt, silicon, and copper are all in a group because they are natural materials, and they are in the same color as a group as such. Another example of a group that was found would be the locations across the United States, which are shown in light mint green, and are Texas, Oregon, Iowa, Virginia, and Michigan. Additionally, the types of corporations used in each step of the process were different depending on the company, but there were similar companies used, so these were grouped. More specifically, for example, there was the use of NVIDIA and Broadcom for the same kind of chip. I put these side-by-side because they are used for the same purpose but are sometimes chosen by certain companies for reasons. I was surprised by how many different components went into the final product, as sometimes it is easy to look at the website as a simple thing to use rather than as a final product of a lot of work, so making this diagram was really interesting to me. Something I found missing from the network that I tried to include in a smaller way would be the people that contribute to the making of all of these steps. We can see the names of the corporations and materials used but not the people who were doing all of the work. This erases those who are doing the work which is sad. It makes invisible the workers in this system that are part of the story. Including more information about the companies, but specifically about the work they do and how that connects to human and environmental rights, would improve this network's strength and explanation abilities. This is because providing this information would give a more complete picture of the situation without glossing over certain topics.

Artist Statement (250 words)

- What does your network reveal about power?
- Who is visible? Who is invisible?

- How would a different network structure tell a different story?

This network shows a lot about power and visibility within power. Something I noticed and began to discuss in the previous paragraph is how the people doing the work behind the scenes of these large corporations or mining sites are erased, or rather labeled by one word such as “NVIDIA” or “Cobalt mine” rather than listing the names of thousands who helped. This makes the people behind the technology invisible, which takes them away from the importance of the story. The people that had to work all day in the mines or design the products were all erased from the network. A network that would include more information about the people in each company, or at least more details about what their lives are like, may tell a more complete story than reducing their entire career to the name of the company. I also wondered more about human rights and environmental rights throughout this network, as there were a lot of the mining sites and data centers built with some questionable ethics. There are many questions that arise from this. Did the people in the local land allow for this, or did the government make all of the decisions for them? Are the mines sustainable, or is it done in a bad way to the land? All of these questions are invisible on this network that only shows the relationships between the pieces. This would allow for more discussion about the rights of AI and how it affects people around the world rather than only thinking about how the string of manufacturing takes place for AI products.

Web Accessibility Improvements

Add to your course website:

- Alt text for all images (Weeks 1-8)
- Color contrast check (use WebAIM Contrast Checker)
- Descriptive link text (not "click here")
- Accessibility statement page

Accessibility Statement Template:

I am still having issues with my website but will be sure to update this as soon as it's fixed.

This site was built by Arianna Griffiths for DH 101.

I have tried to make it accessible by:

- [specific things you did]

If you encounter barriers, please contact me at griffi_a1@denison.edu.